ILA SACHANI

EMBROIDERING DREAMS WITH HER FEET

1 When you enter a tiny room in Moti Vavdi village, Bhavnagar, Gujarat, you will see lots of bright colours.



2 There are many lovely things like cushions, bedcovers, pillows, and more, with beautiful designs.



3 Ila Sachani, a wonderful lady with a big smile, makes all these using a shiny needle to create these designs.



4 She is very good at *Kathiawar* embroidery—a style that needs a lot of skill.



5 Ila Sachani's journey began in the quiet settings of Amreli, Gujarat, where she was born into a farmer's family.



6 From the beginning, life presented its challenges, as Ila was born with her hands hanging loose by her sides.



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1 Threading a needle was hard, but Ila did not give up and became an expert at a young age.



2 Her younger brother and sister helped her too.



3 She learned many styles, even ones from outside Gujarat—Kachchi, Kashmiri, Lucknawi and others.



4 Her parents also helped her learn to do things with her legs, like eating and combing her hair.



5



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1 Word reached the government office in Surat.



2 They were moved by Ila's story and impressed by her work.



3 They decided to display some samples of her embroidery at a state exhibition.



4 This experience opened new doors for Ila.



5 People observed the beauty woven by her feet and readily purchased the creations.



6 Ila was no more a hidden talent, but famous!



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1 Encouraged by this popularity, Ila participated in more exhibitions, not just within the state but at the national level.



2 She received many awards and honours, not just for her art but also the willpower and creativity that her work showed.



3 Ila Sachani, once a farmer's daughter facing a tough challenge, worked hard and became a celebrated artist and receiver of the President's Medal.



4 The most important change for Ila was the new independence. Through her skill, she not only earned a regular income but also found joy in doing what she loved.



5 She proved, through her creations, that challenges can be turned into victories with focus, hard work, positivity and never giving up.

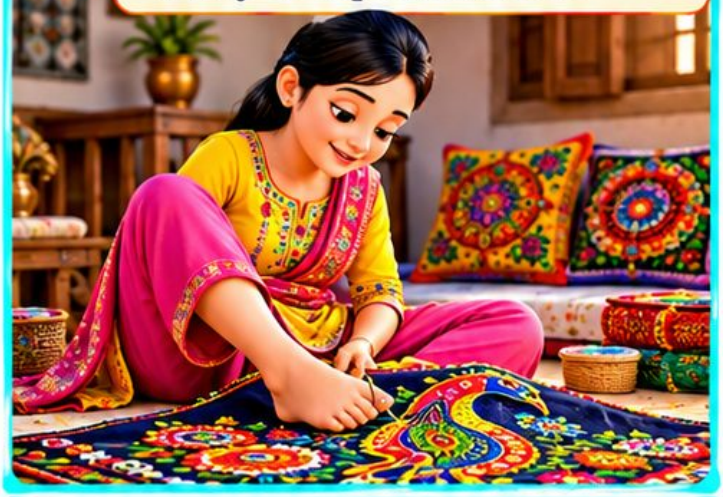


6 Her embroidery, created with her feet, reminds us that art has the power to rise above physical boundaries and touch the soul.



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1 For Ila, embroidery became a way to express herself.



2 At first, she crafted fine designs only for her family and friends, who were awestruck by her talent.



3 They talked about those designs to others.



4 Soon, the people in the village, too, discovered Ila's special skill



5 and the admiration for her work began to spread.



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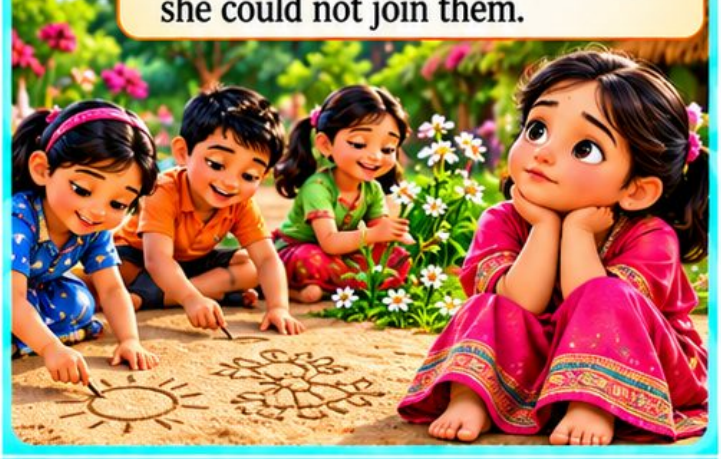


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1 Like other children, she could not use her hands in the usual way.



2 While other small hands drew figures in the sand or plucked wild flowers, she wondered why she could not join them.



3 She too wanted to hold a chalk in her hands and draw figures on a slate.



4 Ila's mother and grandmother encouraged the little girl and were single-minded to help her overcome her challenge.



5 They were skilled in the traditional art of Kathiawar embroidery and decided to share this art with Ila.



6 They taught her to create many beautiful patterns using her feet!

